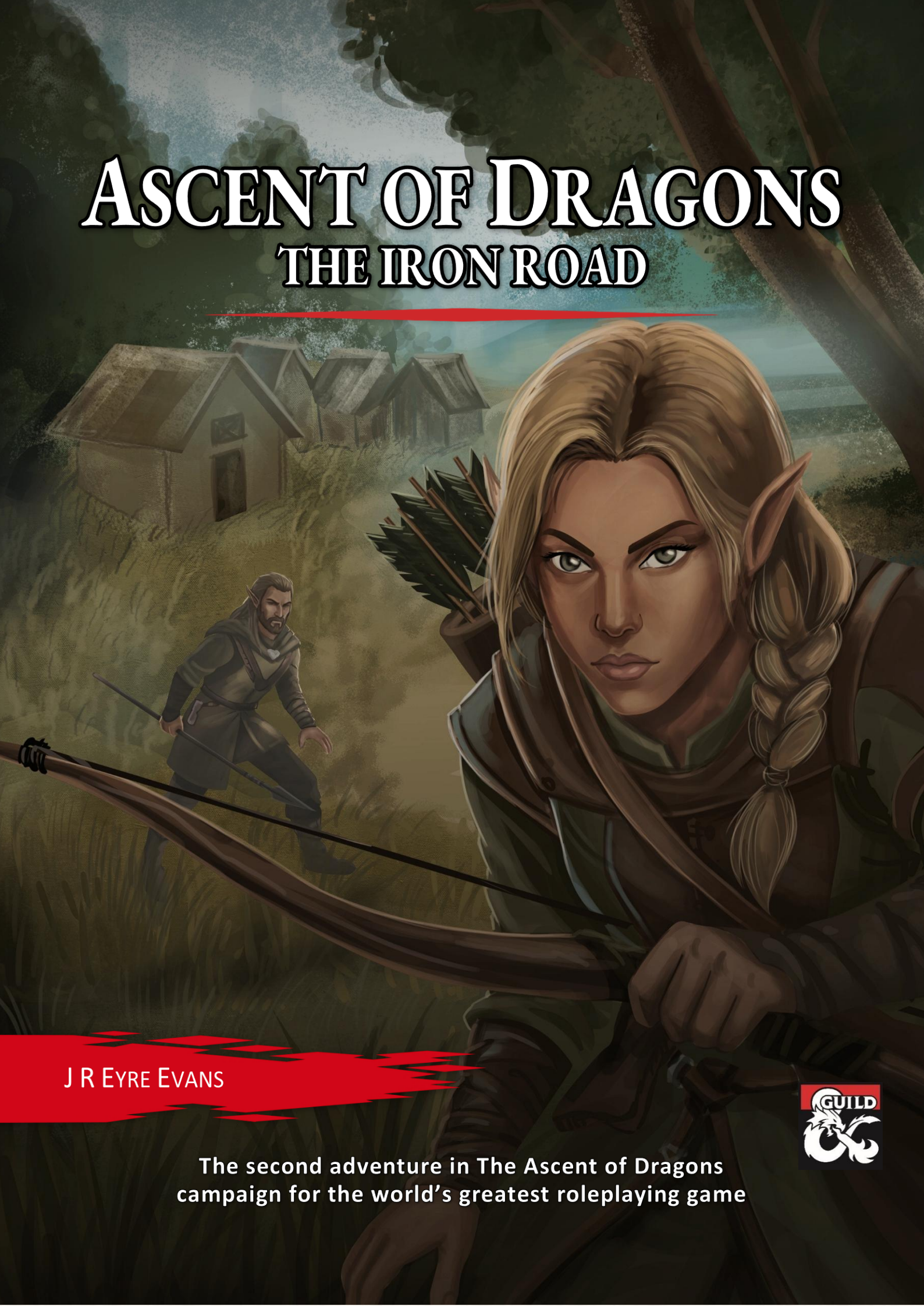
Ascent of Dragons

The Iron Road



J R Eyre Evans

GUILD

The second adventure in The Ascent of Dragons campaign for the world's greatest roleplaying game

Credits

An Orc Wood Adventures Publication

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Battlemaps: 2-Minute Tabletop

Template: Simple Microsoft Word Template by L Hirsbrunner



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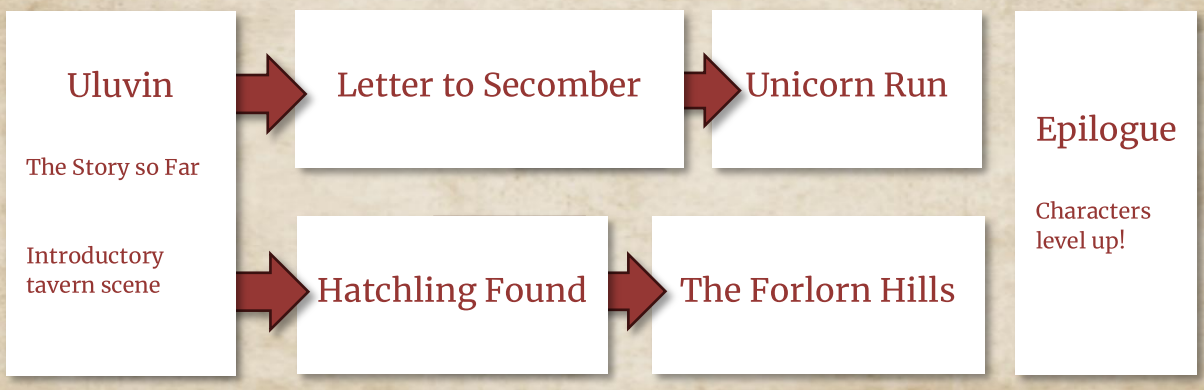
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Notes for DMs

- Designed for **zero preparation time** -you and your players can meet each stage for the first time together.
- Balanced for a party of level 2 adventurers.
- This is module #2 of the campaign of 20 chapters -one for each character level.
- Got your players ready? Head to P.2 and read the recap paragraph aloud!

Adventure Overview





Drazaman

The Story So Far...

As you read the recap, show your players Handout #1 in the appendix, pointing out locations accordingly.

As you may remember, you are currently staying in the Black Bull's Tail, a country tavern in the small village of Uluvin, situated in a usually quiet part of the Delimbiyr Vale on the Iron Road. Here you've been earning some coin by helping out Aubrey Thrall, the village speaker -in the morning you're due to escort some rich merchants into the High Forest.



Swords for hire have been in greater demand since the events last week -an ogre and a group of kobolds raided the village and, something which the villagers haven't stopped talking about since it happened: one night an enormous dragon slowly flew overhead, high up in the night sky.

The Black Bull's Tail

Tavern Prices

Ale (pint, brewed on site)	4 cp
Ale (pint, imported from Goldenfields)	1 sp
Winter Wine (small glass)	1 sp
Bowl of Today's Hotpot	1 sp
Soup (potato, with hunk of bread)	5 cp
Lodgings (includes porridge in morning)	5 sp



You are all sat around a table in the tavern when Aubrey walks up to you with a mildly sheepish expression. "Caradoc and his crew have persuaded Magrat that they've got more experience of taking folks to the High Forest, so, they'll be taking the merchants in tomorrow. However, …" and at this point he digs in his pocket and brings out a folded piece of parchment, "…Fenyg is willing to pay 50 gold for this letter to be handed to some bard in Secomber. Granted, its' not as much as those merchants would have paid you. Feel free to check with Magrat if there's any other work going, but that's all we can muster at the moment."

The box below will help you through likely questions that the characters may have.

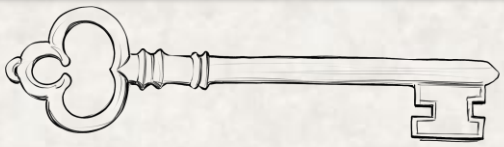
Who is Magrat?
"Magrat, you know her, she's the lady that runs Wen's Wagons. Feel free to see her in the morning if she's got any other work for you."

Who is Fenyg?
"Fenyg? Oh, he's a gnome of some kind...lives up the Unicorn Run. He's a good sort."

Who do we deliver the letter to?
"Ah, now you give that to Owen...I don't know his last name. You'll find him in one of Secomber's taverns and you'd know its him if he's got his little goblin with him."

What can you tell us about Owen?
"Well, apart from that he talks a lot, and laughs at his own jokes, not much. I've only met him once. He must be all right if Fenyg trusts him."

How far is Secomber?
"Oh, about two day's journey."
If they met Gildas last time, add:
"When you do go, do check in on Gildas at the cider farm on the way."



It's up to the characters if they accept this job now or if they decide to check if there are any jobs going at Wen's Wagons. Whichever they choose, go to the relevant page:

- Letter to Secomber: P.3
- Checking Wen's Wagons or simply walking around Uluvin at any point: P.12

Once they've done both, go to the Epilogue : P.18.

Letter to Secomber

If they accept the job, Aubrey hands them the letter and wishes them well. He will pay them on their return. The letter is unsealed -refer to Handout #2 if they choose to read it.



For the journey to Secomber, south along the Iron Road, use this day encounter table. Roll once for each morning and afternoon's travel -they would arrive late afternoon of the second day. Use the nighttime section for their overnight camp and if they've already met Gildas at the cider farm, also include that section.

Encounter Table (either choose or roll)

Roll 1d6	Morning/Afternoon
1	No encounter
2	No encounter
3	Grassy Gnoll
4	"Tax Collectors"
5	Survivor
6	Minstrels



Grassy Gnoll



With a Passive Perception of 12, PCs would notice a creature hiding on a grassy knoll looking at them. This is a gnoll ambush -there are two **gnolls**. They have been lurking on this road for a few days, attacking travelers. They have their accumulated loot hidden in their nearby camp: 17 gp, three daggers and a necklace (worth 25 gp). Use Handout #3 if it helps.

Gnoll

Medium fiend, chaotic evil

AC 15 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 27

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	11	+0	+0
INT	6	-2	-2	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	7	-2	-2

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Gnoll

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

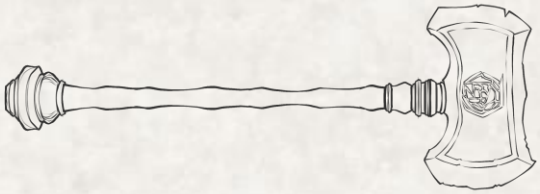
Actions

Rend. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage.

Bone Bow. Ranged Attack Roll: +3, range 150/600 ft. Hit: 6 (1d10 + 1) Piercing damage.

Bonus Action

Rampage (1/Day). Immediately after dealing damage to a creature that is already Bloodied, the gnoll moves up to half its Speed, and it makes one Rend attack.



"Tax Collectors"

Walking towards the party are two **Zhentarim thugs** (on their way to Gildas' cider farm) and, when close by shout, "Oi, have you paid the tax to use this road?". They demand 5 gp from each character. They each carry 1d20 gp and 1d20 sp in their pockets.

Zhentarim Thug

Medium humanoid, neutral

AC 11 **Initiative** +0 (10)

HP 32

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	11	+0	+0	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	11	+0	+0

Gear Short sword, club, 1d10sp

Senses Passive Perception 12

Languages Common

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The thug makes two attacks, using Short sword and Club in any combination.

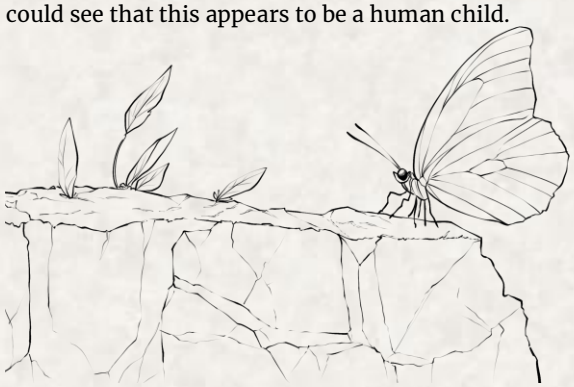
Short sword. Melee Attack Roll: +3, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) Slashing damage.

Club. Melee Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 ft. Hit: 3 (1d4 + 3) Bludgeoning damage.



Survivor

With a Passive Perception of 12, the PCs would notice a small figure in the middle-distance heading towards them across the grass. The figure runs until it falls over, about a quarter of a mile away. If they stop and watch, they see the figure get up slowly and waves and shouts something to them. With a Perception check of 15, they could see that this appears to be a human child.





If they approach the child, they meet Charon, a boy from Secomber travelling with his dad and uncle who were attacked by creatures the PCs would recognize as gnolls. If they reunite Charon with the remainder of his family (the Colics -leatherworkers of Budgeon Lane) in Secomber, they would be very grateful to the PCs and offer them what they can: food and lodging whenever they pass through town.

Minstrels



A group of bards are traveling towards the Dessarin Valley. If questioned, they haven't encountered any dangers on the road so far. One of the bards might take chatting as an opportunity to pick the pocket of whichever character looks the wealthiest. Use **commoner** stats accordingly. If caught in the attempt, they would try and bluff their way out to avoid combat.

Commoner

Medium humanoid, unaligned

AC 10 **Initiative** +0 (10)

HP 4

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	10	+0	+0	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	10	+0	+0

Senses Passive Perception 10

Languages Common

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Actions

Knife or Club. Melee Weapon Attack: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d4) piercing or bludgeoning damage.

Night Time

The PCs inadvertently have set up camp close to where a **boggle** currently lives (stat block on next page). The disgruntled boggle will do what it can to scare them away during the night. Use Handout #4 if needed.





Gildas's Cider Farm

Gildas is pleased to see them and invites them in for refreshment. He hasn't had any repercussions yet from the Zhentarim, but is still nervous. He asks them to pass on a message to Aubrey requesting a few of the Uluvin militia. If they are particularly understanding or sympathetic towards him, have Gildas give them a small one gallon keg of cider -but he does ask them to return the empty keg when they are next passing through.



Boggle

Small fey, chaotic neutral

AC 15 **Initiative** +5 (15)

HP 18

Speed 30ft, Climb 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	8	-1	-1	DEX	20	+5	+5	CON	13	+1	+1
INT	6	-2	-2	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	7	-2	-2

Skills Perception +3, Sleight of Hand +7, Stealth +7

Damage Resistance Fire

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 13

Languages Sylvan

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Boggle Oil. The boggle excretes nonflammable oil from its pores. The boggle chooses whether the oil is slippery or sticky and can change the oil on its skin from one consistency to another as a bonus action.

Slippery Oil: While coated in slippery oil, the boggle gains advantage on Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks made to escape bonds, squeeze through narrow spaces, and end grapples.

Sticky Oil: While coated in sticky oil, the boggle gains advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to grapple and any ability check made to maintain a hold on another creature, a surface, or an object. The boggle can also climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Uncanny Smell. The boggle has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Actions

Pummel. Melee Weapon Attack:+ l to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d6 - 1) bludgeoning damage.

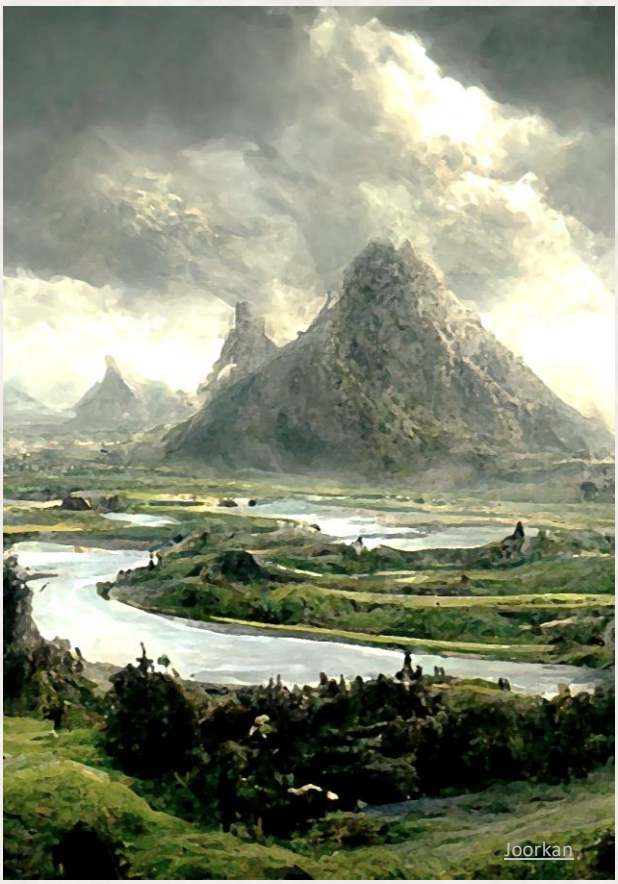
Oil Puddle. The boggle creates a puddle of oil that is either slippery or sticky (boggle's choice). The puddle is 1 inch deep and covers the ground in the boggle's space. The puddle is difficult terrain for all creatures except boggles and lasts for 1 hour.

If the oil is slippery, any creature that enters the puddle's area or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 11 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.

If the oil is sticky, any creature that enters the puddle's area or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 11 Strength saving throw or be restrained. On its turn, a creature can use an action to try to extricate itself from the sticky puddle, ending the effect and moving into the nearest safe unoccupied space with a successful DC 11 Strength check.

Bonus Actions

Dimensional Rift. As a bonus action, the boggle can create an invisible and immobile rift within an opening or frame it can see within 5 feet of it, provided that the space is no bigger than 10 feet on any side. The dimensional rift bridges the distance between that space and any point within 30 feet of it that the boggle can see or specify by distance and direction (such as "30 feet straight up"). While next to the rift, the boggle can see through it and is considered to be next to the destination as well, and anything the boggle puts through the rift (including a portion of its body) emerges at the destination. Only the boggle can use the rift, and it lasts until the end of the boggle's next turn.



Secomber

> Late on the afternoon of the second day, the Delimbiyr Valley opens up before you and up ahead, where the Unicorn Run joins the main river, the peaceful looking town of Secomber is a welcome sight. A few farmsteads and hamlets surround the town and in the far distance beyond it rise the slopes of the High Moors.
>
> Two sullen guards pay you no attention as you pass through the gates. Once inside, it looks like a pleasant place with people going about their business.

If attempting to reunite Charon with his family, they may wish to do this first. Read the players these locations which they might wish to visit:

- Bryn's Oddments (magical and unusual items)
- Doorque & Son (Trading post and agricultural supplies) the local smithy
- Periwinkle's Emporium (general store)
- Tabitha's Taxidermy
- The Seven-Strung Harp
- The Singing Sprite

If they go to a location, refer to the relevant section accordingly. There is a small garrison of 30 guards in the town who patrol in pairs.





Algol

Bryn's Oddments



On display in the front window is a gleaming sword and a shiny suit of armor on a mannequin. Around them are placed several intriguing oddities. The shopkeeper is Bryn, an elderly gnome who is slightly deaf and with a high-pitched voice. See prices below. There are a variety of other items, but these are currently beyond their price range. If they wish to sell magic items, he is on the cautious side, but would buy them at around half the value -perhaps use this link of Sane Magical Prices as a general guide.

Item	Cost (gp)
Armor of Gleaming (Chain)	80
Boots of False Tracks	15
Charlatan's Die	35
Walloping Ammunition (arrow)	20
Tankard of Sobriety	5
Moon-touched Sword (longsword)	30
Staff of Flowers	10
Talking Doll	15

Doorque & Son

This shop is run by a dwarf family. Doorque himself is gruff and drives a hard bargain. He's always keen for an opportunity haggle with adventurers willing to sell loot. He has anything Player's Handbook Adventuring Gear up to the value of 20 gp. He'd be willing to buy items in good condition at around half their published value.



Periwinkle's Emporium

Rather an expensive looking shop for higher end customers. Everything in the Player's Handbook Adventuring Gear is available, but at one and a half times the stated value. Any requests for a discount or haggling here or the PCs attempting to sell items would be treated with disdain.

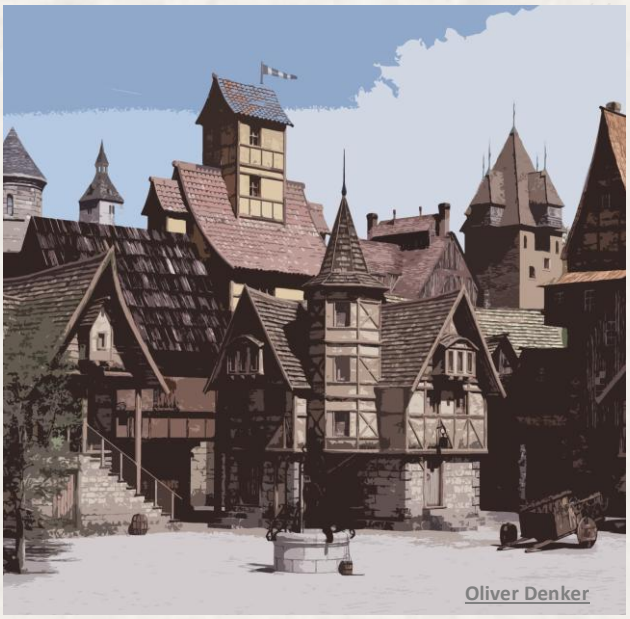
Local Smithy

This is run by Stanley Stonebridge, a chirpy stout halfling -related to the Uluvin Stonebridges. He can make melee weapons and armor to order which would take him 1 day per 10 gp of the item to source materials and make. Prices as per player's handbook.

Tabitha's Taxidermy

The slogan "Animals Live and Stuffed!" is across the doorway. This shop runs as a pet shop and taxidermist. On the shelves are an assortment of stuffed animals: owls, foxes, frogs in various poses and with props such as a walking stick, monocle or miniature top hat. There are also a few live animals in cages and pens (rabbits, hamsters and owls). Several cats are also in the shop, free ranging. Tabitha, an elderly human woman, is always willing to pay good money for dead animals in mint condition for her to stuff; whatever the size, and the more unusual the better.

The Seven-Strung Harp



This substantial inn in the middle of town is one of Secomber's largest buildings. Inside is a busy hubbub of merchants and more well to do clientele than other parts of the town.

Tariff

Ale (pint, Secomber Best) ..... 1 sp
White Wine (small glass) ..... 5 sp

Bowl of Potato Hotpot ..... 2 sp
Soup (ham & pea, with hunk of bread) ..... 1 sp
Roast Meat of the Day (with trimmings) ..... 1 gp

Lodgings (includes breakfast in morning) ..... 5 gp

If they need a cheaper place to stay, there is a hostelry on the outskirts of town. It's a large, shared room of 20 beds and only 10 cp a night. If they stay here, though, they will catch fleas.



When they ask about Owen, on a DC 10 Persuasion check (with advantage if they stand the person a drink), they are directed towards a loud and portly man propping up the bar, currently laughing in response to the punchline of one of his own jokes.

Owen will chat to them merrily. His goblin isn't allowed in this inn -he's currently feasting on the kitchen's leftovers out the back. When they hand him Fenyg's letter, though, his demeanor becomes ashen [*read the box below*]. In addition to this, if they haven't read the letter, he shows it to them (Handout #2).

> After a few moments silence, he downs the remains of his beer and says: "Well, I'll have to pass this up the food chain and see what they'll do." …and then he looks thoughtfully at you and says "If I'm to head to my elders and betters to tell them this, I can't be doing my job here…finding out what's up with the fish." After you look rather puzzled, he adds "Secomber council is paying me 200 gold to find out why there are no more fish coming down the Unicorn Run. The szorp migration didn't happen this year and their fishermen are out of pocket. Take it or leave it, but the job's yours if you wish. The town clerk is the one who put up the money -report to him if you succeed. He'll pay double if you can get the fish, and his taxes flowing again."

The box below will help you through likely questions that the characters may have:

Who is Sânapana?
"You mean 'Shanapan'; they're one of the last remaining unicorns of Unicorn Run -apparently one of the sowers of the High Forest, well, Faerûn Forest in those days."

Who is Montfort?
"Lord Reginald de Montfort is what he calls himself nowadays. Lives at Montfort Castle -even named it after himself. Apparently he's suffering from too much power. Oh and yes, he was a Harper…my recruit."

What is the Glade of Life?
"Legend has it is that that is where new life begins, new races are birthed there, if you believe such a thing. It's at the source of Unicorn Run."

What seems to be happening in the High Forest?
"Montfort is apparently destroying the forest, and the animals therein. Feeding them to baby dragons, according to Fenyg, and training them up. I don't see the point, to be honest, but Fenyg is as truthful as they come so something must be up."

Who is Fenyg?
"Speaker for the Emerald Enclave; I'm his opposite number for my lot. He's a good egg…powerful too. Sees himself as a guardian of the forest."

It's open for the PCs to decide what to do, whether to return directly to Uluvin or investigate Unicorn Run.

The Singing Sprite



Upon entering The Singing Sprite, the smell of stale beer reaches their nostrils. Now more of a drinking inn, this tavern has certainly seemed better days. Clarissa, who runs it will answer their questions providing they are drinking. The beer, which is thin, flat and with a slight vinegary edge is 2 cp a pint. A measure of locally distilled "brandy" is 1 sp each (Constitution Saving Throw DC 10 or Poisoned for 1d4 hours).



Unicorn Run

You head out a short distance from Secomber to the place where the Unicorn Run flows into the Delimbiyr. Here you take the track north that runs alongside the smaller river which gently meanders through the grassy plain. Apart from passing a few shepherds, the journey is undisturbed. After a couple of days travel you see the High Forest. Here the path fords the river at a shallow place and then you follow the trail deeper into the woods.

Which a Passive Perception of 14 they would notice slight acrid smell coming from the waters. If they investigate further (DC 14 Perception), they would detect that the river is tainted slightly with decay.

Eventually the sun begins to get lower in the sky and you make preparations for spending the night in the High Forest.



If they make a lot of noise *at any point*, or, for example, light a fire, they might attract the attention of a nearby **orc** scouting party for the N'grek tribe -one for each PC. With a Passive Perception of 11, they would hear the orcs approach.

In the night (roll to select a time at random) a persistent and ravenous **fox** will arrive, scavenging for scraps.



Sunanda Dey Karmakar

Orc

Medium humanoid, chaotic evil

AC 13 (hide armor) **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 15

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	7	-2	-2	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Intimidation +4

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Orc

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Relentless Endurance (1/day). If reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, they drop to 1 hit point instead.

Actions

Greataxe. Melee Attack Roll: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (1d12 + 3) slashing damage.

Javelin. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Fox

Small beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 3

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	3	-4	-4	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	4	-3	-3	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	7	-2	-2

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +3, Survival +2

Senses Darkvision 30ft, Passive Perception 15

Languages None

CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Traits

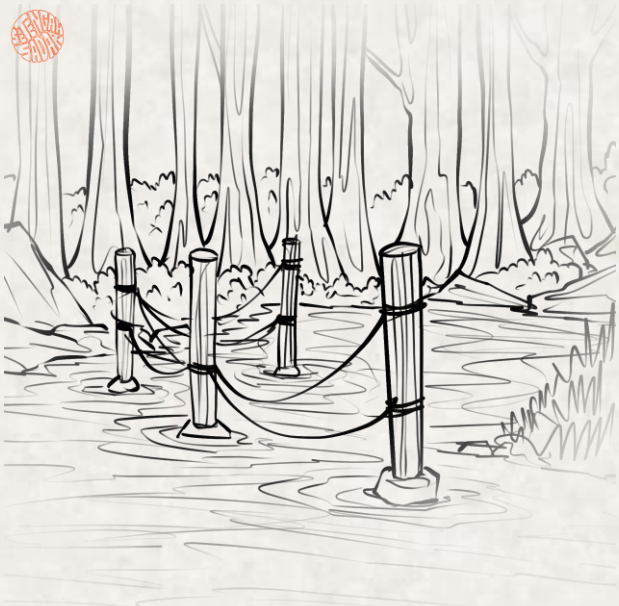
Keen Hearing and Smell. The fox has advantage on all Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Actions

Bite. Melee Attack Roll: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d4) piercing damage.

When they continue on in the morning, read this:

> In the morning, you strike out once more, continuing to follow the river northwards. The trail is so overgrown in places that you have to make your own way through the undergrowth. Whenever you are close to the river, it is giving off the mild but unmistakable odor of decomposition.
>
> After travelling a few hours, you notice some poles sticking out of the water. Getting closer you can see that iron stakes have been driven into the riverbed and some are still linked with wires.



If they investigate further, ask them to roll an investigation/perception check and refer to the table.

Perception/Investigation Check

Roll	What is known
20+	In addition to the reference below, you also find a long-since abandoned camp made by small humanoids on the bank.
15-19	Some of the wires between the posts have fragments of mesh or netting across them -presumably someone has been catching everything downstream. From the rust, the posts look like they've been here for at least a year.
Up to 14	These iron posts have been here for some time.



Once they have looked around, read this:

> You hear the sound of singing and then some laughter. Straining to listen, someone is singing badly with a raspy high-pitched voice a short distance upstream.

As they get closer, they hear the singer strike up again for the next verse. In theory it is a kobold singing in draconic, but if you want, it sings in common:

> *"....so down, down, down to the water we go.*
>
> *Feast, feast, Our Great King's spawn,*
> *Little ones, big ones, grow grow grow.*
> *Fattens you up, grow strong, grow bigs,*
> *Bring us to the great new dawn!"*

> Looking closer, as they continue to sing, it looks like a group of kobolds are spreading out nets across the river further upstream, where you can see more iron posts.



The group of **kobolds** (three for each PC) have a Passive Perception of 8. They have trapped the approach routes to their fishing operation. The PCs will pass through three well-hidden traps -these can be noticed with a Passive Perception of 14. Trap #1 triggers a wasps' nest to fall, releasing an angry **swarm of wasps**; Trap #2 triggers a can containing pebbles to fall, making a loud noise; Trap #3 triggers a weighted net to fall over a 10 ft square area -DC 12 Dexterity Saving Throw or restrained -DC 14 Strength or Dexterity at end of round to escape. See Handout #5.

Kobold

Small humanoid, lawful evil

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 6

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	7	-2	-2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	9	-1	-1
INT	8	-1	-2	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	8	-1	-1

Gear Short spear, Daggers (3)

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Draconic

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The kobold has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the kobold's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the kobold has Disadvantage on ability checks and attack rolls.

Actions

Short spear. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.

If captured and successfully questioned, a kobold would reveal that they are catching fish to feed the Black Wyrm's children. They consider the "Black Wyrm" to be their king -a very large and old black dragon who has set up a lair to the far north. When they have enough fish, they carry them to a "hooman-man" in the "hooman-man camp" (the kobold is referring to Greenmoot).

Swarm of Wasps

Medium swarm of tiny insects, unaligned

AC 11 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 19

Speed Fly 20ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	3	-4	-4	DEX	13	+1	+1	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	1	-5	-5	WIS	7	-2	-2	CHA	1	-5	-5

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities ***Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Prone, Restrained, Stunned***
Senses Blindsight 30 ft., Passive Perception 8
Languages None
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature's space.

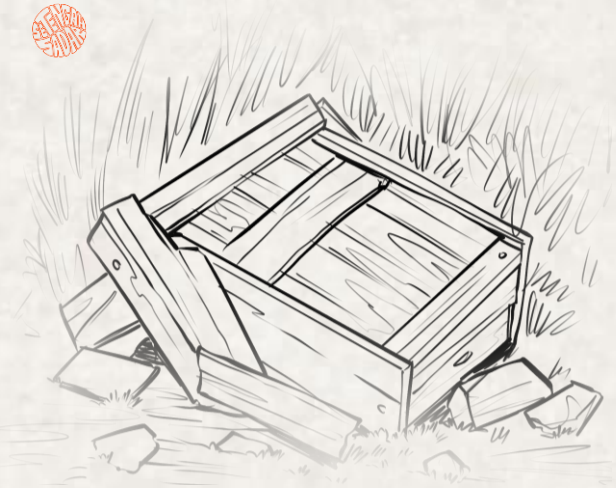
Actions

Bites. Melee Attack Roll: +3, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (2d4 + 1) Poison damage, or 3 (1d4 + 1) Poison damage if the swarm is Bloodied.

As and when they return to Uluvin, the journey takes a few more days and is without incident. As and when they next return to Secomber, they can claim their earnings for resolving the fish problem.

The Broken Crate

Run this sequence whenever the PCs are walking around Uluvin (use Handout #3).



As you walk along the lane in Uluvin, you hear the sound of another one of those merchant caravans passing through. The driver of the lead wagon grunts "Move over!" to you as he trundles past, and you indeed have to move to avoid being hit. As the last wagon passes, you see it hit a bump and when it does so, you see a crate fall off and it lands with a crunch. Before long, the caravan is way off, heading out into the distance towards the High Forest. Looking down at the broken crate, you hear a scratching noise.

Looking inside the crate, you see some broken pieces of shell and a small reptilian face peeping out; behind it are a tiny pair of wings. It looks like a newly hatched copper dragon. It shakes the egg fragments off itself and then it looks at you with a wide eyed expression before giving off a large belch.

All PCs close to the crate should do a DC 10 Dexterity Saving Throw at this point to avoid the small bubble of acidic breath which does 1d4 acid damage or half on a success (stats on P.18 & XX).



After they have responded to this and said what they are going to do next, ask any players who attempt to interact with the hatchling to roll an Animal Handling check, giving advantage or disadvantage accordingly, noting the highest and lowest scores.

She scuttles up the legs and into the arms of the character who rolled highest and then periodically hisses at the character who rolled lowest.

"What's caught your eye?", says a familiar voice from behind you. It's Aubrey, who adds "Oh, he's a sweet little one" when he sees what you're holding.

The players can feel free to roll a Nature check. On a 20 or higher, they'd be able to correct Aubrey if they wish that the hatchling is female.

After a pause Aubrey adds, "Nelly, the old trapper… he's spoken about dragons in the past and seems to know about their ways -he might know what to feed this little 'un. He's in the bar now. I'll go and get him, he'd love to see him."

Let the characters have a chat about what they're going to do with her. Ensure that they or Aubrey note that the caravan was carrying dragons eggs to the High Forest. Let the PCs continue to do as they wish, but either way, for the next scene get Nelly Salt to have a look at the hatchling.

Nelly bends down until he's nose to nose with the hatchling. A smile spreads across his wrinkled face "Well, well, well, a copper. …and what are you doing so far from home?" And with that, she bites him on the nose. He instinctively flinches back, but with blood dripping from his face and, once the shock has worn off, starts laughing.



Nelly then gives his advice, "…up in the mountains, the Forlorn Hills as you call them, lives an old silver dragon in a ruin called Ust Natha Po -I can tell you the way. Now, this one's a copper and there aren't them about these parts, but the silver one, Lenastyll he's called, he'd be able to tell you what to do with her. Also, you can tell him that they're carting metallic dragon eggs to the forest, for whatever reason."

Hopefully they will agree to Nelly's plan. If need be, Magrat from Wen's Wagons could see it, ask them what they're going to do with it, hear Nelly's proposal and then offer them enough gold to take the hatchling to the silver dragon.

Nelly describes the way to go with obvious landmarks. He warns you to watch out for the weather, which can change quickly on the higher slopes. He adds that a campfire at night should keep the local pack of wolves away and also to watch out for Boggyn, an ogre that lives in a cave near the track.

If they suggest Nelly comes too, he'd say he's far too old and would slow them up.



The Forlorn Hills

Following Salt's directions, and carrying the little hatchling, you take the Iron Road north for a few hours. As he said, there on the left is an abandoned shepherd's hut and you can see a trail leading off past it, up the hillside.

The trek is three day's walk and two nights out in the wilds. Roll for events once a day on the table below and refer to that section; for camping out, go to the Night Time section. Use Handouts #6 & 7 accordingly.



Additionally, for the arduous trek, make two Constitution Saving Throws a day. The DC in the morning is 5 and the DC in the afternoon is 10. Any fail results in the character gaining one level of exhaustion. Each day establish a marching order.

Slippage

By the roll of a dice, select a character at random. Whilst walking along a stony path close to the edge of a large drop, the stones give way under your foot and you slip - roll a DC 10 Dexterity Saving Throw. The character immediately behind may assist if they wish by attempting to grab them -they roll to hit AC 10 to achieve a grapple. If both rolls fail, that character falls down a 30 foot drop.

Events Table (either choose or roll)

Roll 1d8	Encounter/Event
1	No event
2	Slippage
3	Mountain Stream
4	Storm
5	Wolves
6	Cave
7	Blood Hawks
8	Thick Fog



Mountain Stream

You come to a beautiful mountain stream and the hatchling makes it clear that she wants to get to it. Given the opportunity, she has a drink and a playful swim before scuttling back to her chosen character.

Storm

On the horizon you see storm clouds building. After an hour, you can see that they are building and getting closer. Get everyone to roll a Survival or Nature Check:

Survival/Nature Check

Roll	What is known
15+	You need to find shelter as soon as possible
10-14	Maybe it'll be safe enough, but it looks like you're going to get wet
Up to 5	Actually, you think that the storm will miss you

If they choose to find shelter, roll Survival/Perception accordingly; with a success on a 15 they spot a fallen tree or a place out of the wind to wait until the storm passes. If they are out in the storm without shelter, they need to do a DC 15 Constitution Saving Throw or gain one level of exhaustion.

Wolves

A small pack of **wolves** (1d4+3) is tracking the party. They have picked up their scent about a mile behind them down the track and are getting closer. From their baying howls getting increasingly closer, the party will have time to prepare as they deem fit.

Wolf

Medium beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 11

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	3	-4	-4	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	6	-2	-2

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages None
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The wolf has Advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of the wolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Bite. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage. If the target has a Strength Ability Score of 13 or less, it has the Prone condition.

Cave

The path runs 10 feet below the mouth of a large cave. From the smell of the remains of dead animals, the **ogre** (stats on next page) is still there. If they chose to avoid this part of the path, the journey will take them an extra half day of travel. If they wish to creep past, they must succeed a Stealth Check of DC 8. On a failure, the ogre will come out and, pleased to find prey larger than a fox, will attack with relish.



Ogre

Large giant, chaotic evil

AC 11 (hide armor) **Initiative** -1 (9)

HP 64

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	19	+4	+4	DEX	8	-1	-1	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	5	-3	-3	WIS	7	-2	-2	CHA	7	-2	-2

Gear Greatclub, Javelins (3)

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 8

Languages Common, Giant

CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Actions

Greatclub. Melee Attack Roll: +6, reach 5 ft. Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) Bludgeoning damage.

Blood Hawks

In the distance, you see some birds of prey circling. After a while you notice that there are more of them and that they are getting closer. A DC 10 Nature check would identify these as **blood hawks** (three for each character). They swoop down to attack, but will fly off if reduced to around half their number.

Thick Fog

Thick fog descends and they can barely see further than 5 feet in front of them. If they decide to wait until it clears, they add half a day to their journey. If they decide to continue, whoever is in front needs to roll three Survival/Perception Checks DC 10. Roll on the consequences table after any failures:

Survival/Perception Check

Roll 1d6	Consequence
1/2	You come to the edge of a precipice without realising. Dexterity Saving Throw DC 15 or fall down a 1d4 x 10 feet drop.
3/4	You lead the party into a bog and struggle to get out. Everyone has to do a Constitution Saving Throw DC 10 or receive one level of exhaustion.
5/6	You inadvertently take the wrong path and travel several hours. Add a half day to the total journey time.

Night Time

For the any night they have to camp out in the wilds: if they follow Salt's advice and have a fire, the night will be peaceful. Without a fire, run the 'Wolves' section.

By the second evening they should reach the abandoned watch tower. It is dry inside and, apart from a family of rooks periodically squawking, the night is peaceful.



Blood Hawk

Small beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 17

Speed 10ft, Fly 60ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	6	-2	-2	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	3	-4	-4	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	5	-3	-3

Skills Perception +6

Senses Passive Perception 16

Languages None

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The hawk has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the hawk's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Beak. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage, or 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage if the target is Bloodied.





Ust Natha-Po

Unless otherwise delayed, on the afternoon of the third day of their trek, read this:

> The skies brighten and they see their destination up ahead: the ruins of an ancient building. From the carved white stone that remains, it would have been a beautiful sight in it's prime. With no immediate sign of the silver dragon, you approach his lair with some trepidation.



Lenastyll's Lair

> Your footsteps seem to echo as you step into the ancient ruin. The wind whistles as it blows through the archways that still stand. One large archway catches your gaze, a large entrance to what was once perhaps a chapel.

Give the players the opportunity to (hopefully) announce their arrival in a respectful manner. However this happens, when ready read:

> You hear a loud exhale from deep inside the ruin and then the slow tread of something large moving. There is a brushing sound as it's hide scrapes the stone walls. These sounds get louder until a huge shape is visible in the shadows and his head emerges -that of an old silver dragon, with kind, wise eyes blinking in the sunlight.



This next sequence assumes that the characters are respectful. If they are not, Lenastyll (**adult silver dragon -MM**) would use his Frightful Presence as necessary.

> Lenastyll sniffs the air and then, still sniffing, moves closer to where the copper hatchling is perched, "Ho there little one! What are you doing so far from home?" The hatchling merely looks back, transfixed with wide eyes.

Now begins a discourse between the characters and Lenastyll. He will ask these questions and cover these points:

Where did you find her?

Were there any more dragon's eggs?

Where were the wagons going?

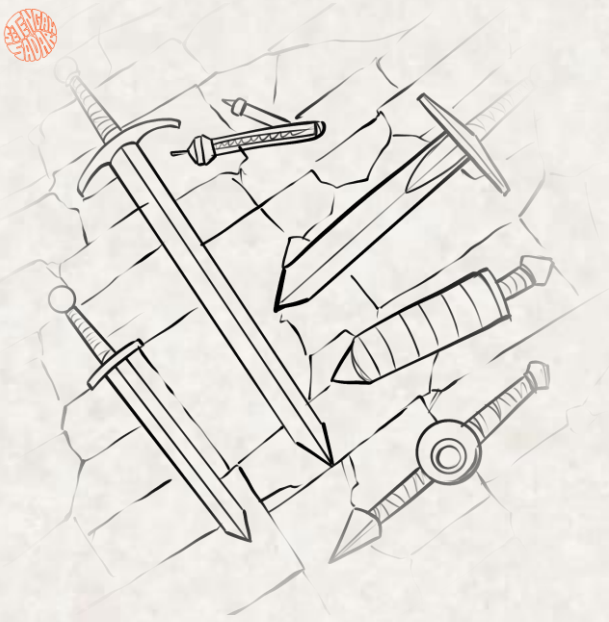
His Conclusions:

- The hatchling likes them and has, effectively, adopted them; they should bring her up, but remember to give her some fish
- She needs a name, a draconic name. Her name is Cupruluviniax -the female form of "copper from Uluvin".
- It will be their responsibility, in time, to teach her to speak Common and Draconic.

His Proposal:

- He is concerned about this apparent trade of metallic dragon's eggs and wishes them to carefully investigate, perhaps finding a reason to enter the camp in the forest.
- He has previously heard other rumors of ill tidings from the High Forest of late and would like to know more.
- He trusts the trapper, Nelly Salt. They can use him to pass on any information back.

"…and as my eyes and ears, assuming you agree to my proposal, you will need some extra help." He then looks around at each member of the group in turn and says "Yes, I think I can *lend* each of you something from my hoard to assist.", before turning around and returning to his lair. After a few minutes, he comes back, carrying a large bundle of items which he places on the ground. "You may each *borrow* one of these, if you wish, but this", he now addresses Cupruluviniax directly, "Is yours to keep." And he presents her with a ring, which she sniffs and then accepts as a bracelet around her wrist.



The items Lenastyll places on the ground depend on the composition of the party; ideally each character can choose to borrow one low level magical item with a permanent effect:

- **Shortsword +1**; *this sword has a slightly curved blade and looks to be of elven crafting*
- **Battleaxe +1**; *once wielded by Dryndod Whychder, dwarven warrior of the High Moors*
- **Shield +1**; *this blessed shield has the crest of a rampant lion on a blue background*
- **Greatsword +1**; *this blade used to belong to a rather rude fire giant called Thrykar*
- **Immovable Rod**; *this belonged to a rogue who thought they could pilfer the hoard of an adult silver dragon with ease*
- **+1 Arcane Grimoire**; *this belonged to an impudent young wizard who had to be taught a lesson on politeness*
- **+1 Dragonhide Belt**; *this belt was in a chest, along with other items, found buried in a cave in the Greypeak Mountains*
- **Adamantine Plate Armor**; *this suit of armor was purchased from Stead & Prichguard, Quality Armorers in Neverwinter*
- **+1 Bloodwell Vial**; *this was won by Lenastyll in a game of chance with a brass dragon*
- **Mace of Smiting**; *Lenastyll is rather fond of this…it belonged to a good friend of his who has now passed away -a cleric called Brother Goland*
- **Pipes of Haunting**; *if any player chooses these, Lenastyll says that they can keep them as they put his teeth on edge*



Cupruluviniax's ring is a *Ring of Draconic Protection*: it can only be attuned to by a dragon or those with draconic ancestry; the bearer gains advantage on any area of effect saving throws, receiving no damage on a success and only half damage on a fail. Additionally, any area of effect damage cannot be fatal and at most reduces the bearer to zero hits points and they do death saving throws as normal.

Once concluded, Lenastyll thanks them once again and, looking slightly bashful, passes Cupruluviniax a tiny intricately carved brass ball with a smaller ball inside and gives it a little tinkle. The tiny dragon takes it gleefully and begins to play with it.

For the journey back to Uluvin, continue to roll for encounters but only roll once a day for the Constitution Saving Throw with a DC 5 as it is more downhill. During the nights they might be woken by a tinkling brass ball.

Epilogue

Once the characters have been to Secomber, the Forlorn Hills and returned to Uluvin, read this:

> It's late in the day when you at last reach the bar of the Black Bull's Tail. At last, you can put your feet up once more and enjoy the local ale. Aubrey soon enters and is eager to hear of your news, standing you a round of drinks. The brass bell tinkles, and he smiles when he sees the little hatchling with you, safe and well. You have work ahead, but, for now, you've earnt a rest.

The characters level up to level 3!

Cupruluviniax has been growing and her stats will increase too. Ask every character to do an Animal Handling Check. Whoever gets the highest is her preferred "parent" for the next adventure and she will skuttle over to them; she will shun/periodically hiss at whoever got the lowest.





Cupruluviniax

Tiny dragon, chaotic good

AC 11 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 3

Speed 10ft, Climb 5ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	8	-1	-1	DEX	12	+1	+3	CON	13	+1	+3
INT	14	+2	+2	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	13	+1	+1

Skills Perception +3

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 13

Languages None

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Actions

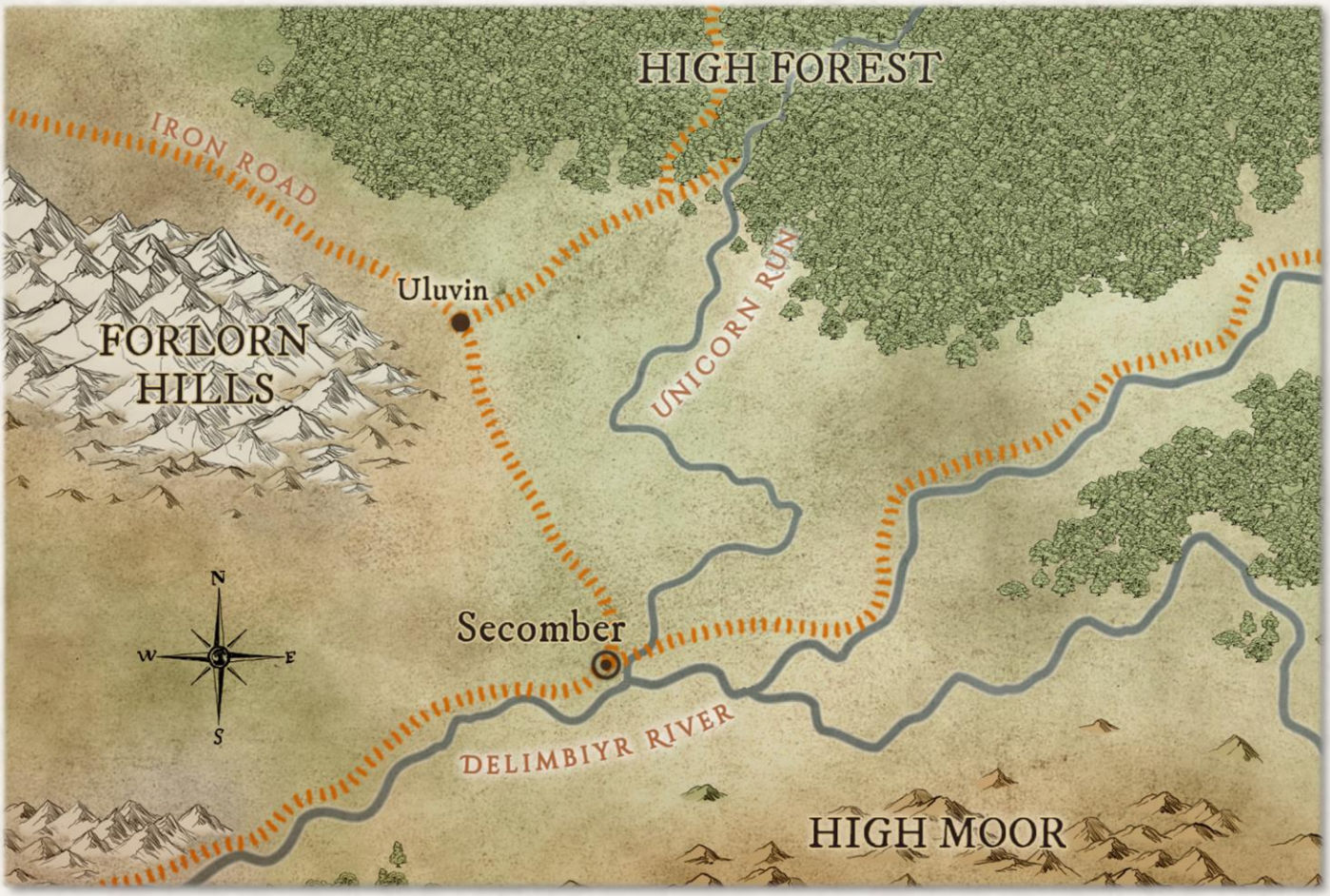
Rend. Melee Attack Roll: +2, reach 5 ft. Hit: 2 piercing damage.

Acid Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw*: DC 10, each creature in a 5-foot-Cone. *Failure*: 1 (1d4) Acid damage. *Success*: Half damage.



Appendix

Handout #1





Handout #2

Owen, greetings in name of Sânapana; may their wisdom guide your steps.

Since I last wrote it has become darker. Montfort's fist and axe continue to lay waste to the forest folk and there are ill tidings from the Glade of Life -but I need to see this with my own eyes to believe it. Those that dare to stay and fight are soon crushed. The elf councils speak of their departure from the High Forest and many of the fey folk have already flown to their wild. Montfort was one of yours, trained by your hand, cut from the same cloth; the blood and sap that spills is on the Harper's hands. Send word to them, that they bring him to justice swiftly. I am writing this by hand; if I have to say this to your face, I will not mince my words.

Fenyg

Handout #3



2-Minute Tabletop

1 square = 2 feet

Handout #4



2-Minute Tabletop

1 square = 2 feet

Handout #5



2-Minute Tabletop

1 square = 5 feet

Handout #6



2-Minute Tabletop

1 square = 5 feet


HANDOUT #7
2-Minute Tabletop
1 square = 5 feet

Stat Blocks

Blood Hawk

Small beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 17

Speed 10ft, Fly 60ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	6	-2	-2	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	3	-4	-4	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	5	-3	-3

Skills Perception +6

Senses Passive Perception 16

Languages None

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The hawk has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the hawk's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Beak. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage, or 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage if the target is Bloodied.

Commoner

Medium humanoid, unaligned

AC 10 **Initiative** +0 (10)

HP 4

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	10	+0	+0	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	10	+0	+0
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	10	+0	+0

Gear Occupational tool, 1d10cp

Senses Passive Perception 10

Languages Common

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Actions

Knife or Club. Melee Weapon Attack: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d4) piercing or bludgeoning damage.



Boggle

Small fey, chaotic neutral

AC 15 **Initiative** +5 (15)

HP 18

Speed 30ft, Climb 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	8	-1	-1	DEX	20	+5	+5	CON	13	+1	+1
INT	6	-2	-2	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	7	-2	-2

Skills Perception +3, Sleight of Hand +7, Stealth +7

Damage Resistance Fire

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 13

Languages Sylvan

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Boggle Oil. The boggle excretes nonflammable oil from its pores. The boggle chooses whether the oil is slippery or sticky and can change the oil on its skin from one consistency to another as a bonus action.

Slippery Oil: While coated in slippery oil, the boggle gains advantage on Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks made to escape bonds, squeeze through narrow spaces, and end grapples.

Sticky Oil: While coated in sticky oil, the boggle gains advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to grapple and any ability check made to maintain a hold on another creature, a surface, or an object. The boggle can also climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Uncanny Smell. The boggle has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Actions

Pummel. Melee Weapon Attack:+ l to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d6 - 1) bludgeoning damage.

Oil Puddle. The boggle creates a puddle of oil that is either slippery or sticky (boggle's choice). The puddle is 1 inch deep and covers the ground in the boggle's space. The puddle is difficult terrain for all creatures except boggles and lasts for 1 hour.

If the oil is slippery, any creature that enters the puddle's area or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 11 Dexterity saving throw or fall prone.

If the oil is sticky, any creature that enters the puddle's area or starts its turn there must succeed on a DC 11 Strength saving throw or be restrained. On its turn, a creature can use an action to try to extricate itself from the sticky puddle, ending the effect and moving into the nearest safe unoccupied space with a successful DC 11 Strength check.

Bonus Actions

Dimensional Rift. As a bonus action, the boggle can create an invisible and immobile rift within an opening or frame it can see within 5 feet of it, provided that the space is no bigger than 10 feet on any side. The dimensional rift bridges the distance between that space and any point within 30 feet of it that the boggle can see or specify by distance and direction (such as "30 feet straight up"). While next to the rift, the boggle can see through it and is considered to be next to the destination as well, and anything the boggle puts through the rift (including a portion of its body) emerges at the destination. Only the boggle can use the rift, and it lasts until the end of the boggle's next turn.



Cupruluviniax

Tiny dragon, chaotic good

AC 11 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 3

Speed 10ft, Climb 5ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	8	-1	-1	DEX	12	+1	+3	CON	13	+1	+3
INT	14	+2	+2	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	13	+1	+1

Skills Perception +3

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 13

Languages None

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Actions

Rend. Melee Attack Roll: +2, reach 5 ft. Hit: 2 piercing damage.

Acid Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw*: DC 10, each creature in a 5-foot-Cone. *Failure*: 1 (1d4) Acid damage. *Success*: Half damage.

Fox

Small beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 3

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	3	-4	-4	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	4	-3	-3	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	7	-2	-2

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +3, Survival +2

Senses Darkvision 30ft, Passive Perception 15

Languages None

CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Traits

Keen Hearing and Smell. The fox has advantage on all Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Actions

Bite. Melee Attack Roll: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 2 (1d4) piercing damage.

Gnoll

Medium fiend, chaotic evil

AC 15 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 27

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	11	+0	+0
INT	6	-2	-2	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	7	-2	-2

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Gnoll

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Actions

Rend. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage.

Bone Bow. Ranged Attack Roll: +3, range 150/600 ft. Hit: 6 (1d10 + 1) Piercing damage.

Bonus Action

Rampage (1/Day). Immediately after dealing damage to a creature that is already Bloodied, the gnoll moves up to half its Speed, and it makes one Rend attack.

Kobold

Small humanoid, lawful evil

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 6

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	7	-2	-2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	9	-1	-1
INT	8	-1	-2	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	8	-1	-1

Gear Short spear, Daggers (3)

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Draconic

CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

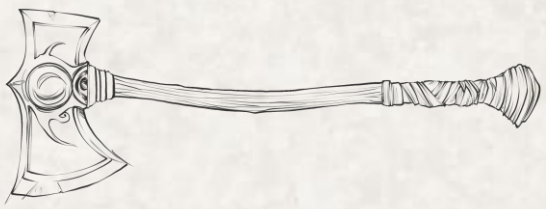
Traits

Pack Tactics. The kobold has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the kobold's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the kobold has Disadvantage on ability checks and attack rolls.

Actions

Short spear. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.



Ogre

Large giant, chaotic evil

AC 11 (hide armor) **Initiative** -1 (9)

HP 64

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	19	+4	+4	DEX	8	-1	-1	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	5	-3	-3	WIS	7	-2	-2	CHA	7	-2	-2

Gear Greatclub, Javelins (3)

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 8

Languages Common, Giant

CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Actions

Greatclub. Melee Attack Roll: +6, reach 5 ft. Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) Bludgeoning damage.

Javelin. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +6, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) Piercing damage.

Orc

Medium humanoid, chaotic evil

AC 13 (hide armor) **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 15

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	12	+1	+1	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	7	-2	-2	WIS	11	+0	+0	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Intimidation +4

Senses Darkvision 60ft, Passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Orc

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Relentless Endurance (1/day). If reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, they drop to 1 hit point instead.

Actions

Greataxe. Melee Attack Roll: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (1d12 + 3) slashing damage.

Javelin. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Swarm of Wasps

Medium swarm of tiny insects, unaligned

AC 11 **Initiative** +1 (11)

HP 19

Speed Fly 20ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	3	-4	-4	DEX	13	+1	+1	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	1	-5	-5	WIS	7	-2	-2	CHA	1	-5	-5

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities ***Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Prone, Restrained, Stunned***
Senses Blindsight 30 ft., Passive Perception 8
Languages None
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature's space.

Actions

Bites. Melee Attack Roll: +3, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (2d4 + 1) Poison damage, or 3 (1d4 + 1) Poison damage if the swarm is Bloodied.

Wolf

Medium beast, unaligned

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)

HP 11

Speed 40ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	12	+1	+1
INT	3	-4	-4	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	6	-2	-2

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages None
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The wolf has Advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of the wolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Bite. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage. If the target has a Strength Ability Score of 13 or less, it has the Prone condition.

Zhentarim Thug

Medium humanoid, neutral

AC 11 **Initiative** +0 (10)

HP 32

Speed 30ft

		MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV			MOD	SAV
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	11	+0	+0	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	11	+0	+0

Gear Short sword, club, 1d10sp

Senses Passive Perception 12

Languages Common

CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The thug makes two attacks, using Short sword and Club in any combination.

Short sword. Melee Attack Roll: +3, reach 5 ft. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) Slashing damage.

Club. Melee Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 ft. Hit: 3 (1d4 + 3) Bludgeoning damage.

Actions

Magic Items

Arcane Grimoire +1

Wondrous item, uncommon (+1), rare (+2), very rare (+3) (requires attunement by a wizard)
While you are holding this leather-bound book, you can use it as a spellcasting focus for your wizard spells, and you gain a bonus to spell attack rolls and to the saving throw DCs of your wizard spells. The bonus is determined by the book's rarity. You can use this book as a spellbook. In addition, when you use your Arcane Recovery feature, you can increase the number of spell slot levels you regain by 1.

Adamantine Armor

Armor (Any Medium or Heavy, Except Hide Armor), Uncommon
This suit of armor is reinforced with adamantine, one of the hardest substances in existence. While you're wearing it, any Critical Hit against you becomes a normal hit.

Armor of Gleaming

Armor (Any Light, Medium, or Heavy), Common
This armor never gets dirty.

Bloodwell Vial +1

Wondrous item, uncommon (+1), rare (+2), very rare (+3) (requires attunement by a sorcerer)
To attune to this vial, you must place a few drops of your blood into it. The vial can't be opened while your attunement to it lasts. If your attunement to the vial ends, the contained blood turns to ash. You can use the vial as a spellcasting focus for your spells while wearing or holding it, and you gain a bonus to spell attack rolls and to the saving throw DCs of your sorcerer spells. The bonus is determined by the vial's rarity. In addition, when you roll any Hit Dice to recover hit points while you are carrying the vial, you can regain 5 sorcery points. This property of the vial can't be used again until the next dawn.



Boots of False Tracks

Wondrous Item, Common (Requires Attunement)
While wearing these boots, you can have them leave tracks like those of any kind of Humanoid of your size.

Charlatans' Die

Wondrous Item, Common (Requires Attunement)
Whenever you roll this six-sided die, you can control which number it rolls.

Immovable Rod

Rod, Uncommon
This iron rod has a button on one end. You can take a Utilize action to press the button, which causes the rod to become magically fixed in place. Until you or another creature takes a Utilize action to push the button again, the rod doesn't move, even if it defies gravity. The rod can hold up to 8,000 pounds of weight. More weight causes the rod to deactivate and fall. A creature can take a Utilize action to make a DC 30 Strength (Athletics) check, moving the fixed rod up to 10 feet on a successful check.

Mace of Smiting

Weapon (Mace), Rare
You gain a +1 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon. The bonus increases to +3 when you use the weapon to attack a Construct.
When you roll a 20 on an attack roll made with this weapon, the target takes an extra 7 Bludgeoning damage, or 14 Bludgeoning damage if it's a Construct. If a Construct has 25 Hit Points or fewer after taking this damage, it is destroyed.

Moon-Touched Sword

Weapon (Glaive, Greatsword, Longsword, Rapier, Scimitar, or Shortsword), Common
In Darkness, the unsheathed blade of this weapon sheds



moonlight, creating Bright Light in a 15-foot radius and Dim Light for an additional 15 feet.

Pipes of Haunting

Wondrous Item, Uncommon
These pipes have 3 charges and regain 1d3 expended charges daily at dawn. You can take a Magic action to play them and expend 1 charge to create an eerie, spellbinding tune. Each creature of your choice within 30 feet of you must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or have the Frightened condition for 1 minute. A creature that fails the save repeats it at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. A creature that succeeds on its save is immune to the effect of these pipes for 24 hours.

Ring of Draconic Protection

Ring, Rare (Requires Attunement by a dragon or creature with draconic ancestry)
The bearer gains advantage on any area of effect saving throws, receiving no damage on a success and only half

damage on a fail. Additionally, any area of effect damage cannot be fatal and at most reduces the bearer to zero hits points and they do death saving throws as normal.

Staff of Flowers

Staff, Common
This wooden staff has 10 charges. While holding it, you can take a Magic action to expend 1 charge from the staff and cause a flower to sprout from a patch of earth or soil within 5 feet of yourself, or from the staff itself. Unless you choose a specific kind of flower, the staff creates a mild-scented daisy. The flower is harmless and nonmagical, and it grows or withers as a normal flower would.
Regaining Charges. The staff regains 1d6 + 4 expended charges daily at dawn. If you expend the last charge, roll 1d20. On a 1, the staff turns into flower petals and is lost forever.

Shield +1

Armor (shield), uncommon
While holding this Shield, you have a bonus to Armor Class determined by the Shield's rarity, in addition to the Shield's normal bonus to AC.

Talking Doll

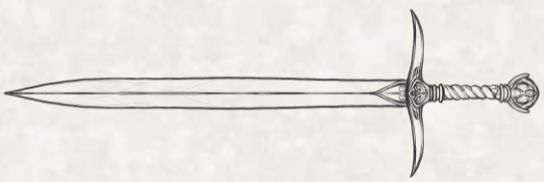
Wondrous Item, Common (Requires Attunement)
While this doll is within 5 feet of you, you can spend a Short Rest telling it to say up to six phrases, none of which can be more than six words long, and set a condition under which the doll speaks each phrase. You can also replace old phrases with new ones. Whatever the condition, it must occur within 5 feet of the doll to make it speak. For example, whenever someone picks up the doll, it might say, "I want a piece of candy." The doll's phrases are lost when your Attunement to the doll ends.

Tankard of Sobriety

Wondrous Item, Common
This tankard has a stern face sculpted into one side. You can drink ale, wine, or any other nonmagical alcoholic beverage poured into it without becoming inebriated. The tankard has no effect on magical liquids or harmful substances such as poison.

Walloping Ammunition

Weapon (Any Ammunition), Common
A creature hit by this ammunition must succeed on a DC 10 Strength saving throw or have the Prone condition.



Weapon +1

Weapon (Any Simple or Martial), Uncommon (+1), Rare (+2), or Very Rare (+3)
You have a bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon. The bonus is determined by the weapon's rarity.

Ascent of Dragons 5.5e

- A campaign of 20 DM-friendly modules —one for each level
- Designed for zero DM preparation time
- Over 14,000 ebooks downloaded of 5e version
- Over 900 pages of ready-to-go adventuring content!









Quotes from lovely reviewers of 5e version on DMs Guild:

"My players are thoroughly enjoying this series"

"Love this adventure very much"

"The story is so good! It keeps me hooked every chapter"

"As a GM, I absolutely love the lack of prep needed. Honestly, it's allowed me to GM again because real life takes so much time (I'm a father, husband, work a full-time job, etc)"



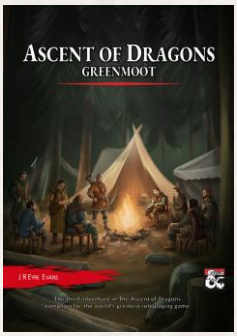
Ascent of Dragons
Dungeon Master's Companion

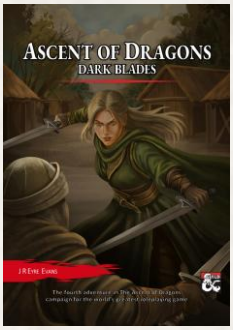
The *Ascent of Dragons* campaign is designed to be able to pick up and play with zero DM preparation time. However, many DMs want to plan ahead and to explore the story before their players arrive. To assist them, the *Dungeon Master's Companion* has:

- The campaign backstory from Bahamut, Tiamat and Alaundo's perspective
- A summary of what Tiamat is planning
- Overviews of the campaign including by location & story arc
- Tips for the Session Zero
- A walkthrough chapter by chapter
- 3 new playable 5.5e species: Ursuline, Centaur & Unicorn
- Help for DMing the overall campaign


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FIRST AMONG EQUALS
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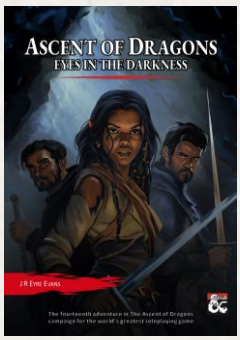

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THE HIGH FORESTERS
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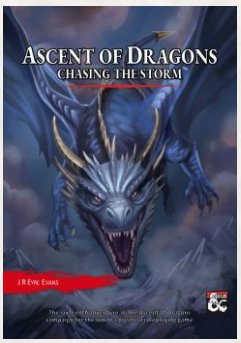

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UNDER SIEGE
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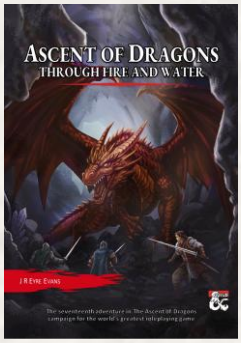

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'TIL BREAK OF DAY
J R Eyre Evans

Protect Sword Coast from the Wrath of the Dragon Queen!

The fragile peace of the Delimbiyr Vale is disturbed once more. There is unsettling activity in the normally quiet nearby High Forest. This typically sleepy gateway to the Unicorn Run is precariously close to the epicenter of Tiamat's plans on wreaking her revenge on the metallic dragons which could, if not thwarted, threaten Sword Coast and all of Faerûn!

